# The Legend of Rock Paper Scissors

## By Drew Daywalt

## INTRODUCTION

*You've played the game . . . . Now gather round and hear the legend of the three fierce warriors who brought the game to life. The Legend of Rock Paper Scissors by Drew Daywalt.*

**NARRATOR:** Long ago, in an ancient and distant realm called the Kingdom of Backyard, there lived a warrior named ROCK.

**ROCK:** *(Rock enters and postures in pantomime)*

**NARRATOR:** Rock was the strongest in all the land, but he was sad because no one could give him a worthy challenge. Rock traveled to the mysterious Forest of Over by the Tire Swing, where he met a warrior who hung on a rope, holding a giant's underwear.

**ROCK:** *(Rock spots Clothes Pin and yells up to him)* Drop that underwear and battle me, you ridiculous wooden clip-man!

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**CLOTHES PIN:** I will pinch you and make you cry, Rock Warrior!

**NARRATOR:** *(In the voice of a ring announcer)* Rock versus Clothespin! *(An epic battle ensures – actors depicts both characters in the battle with lots of sounds, but no real words)* Rock is victorious! *(Returns to normal Narrator voice)* Even though he had won, Rock was still unsatisfied. So he journeyed on, to the mystical Tower of Grandma's Favorite Apricot Tree. There he was met by an odd and delicious fruit.

**ROCK:** *(Rock spots Apricot and yells up to him)* You, sir, look like a fuzzy little butt.

**APRICOT:** What?! I challenge you to a duel! I will beat you, Rock, with my tart and tangy sweetness!

**ROCK:** Then let us battle!

**NARRATOR:** *(In the voice of a ring announcer)* Rock versus Apricot! *(An epic battle ensures – actors depicts both characters in the battle with lots of sounds, but no real words)* Rock is victorious!

**APRICOT:** Ugh, I am smooshed!

**ROCK:** And yet, smooshing you has brought me no joy.

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**NARRATOR:** The battle had been too easy. So Rock left the Kingdom of Backyard, still in search of a worthy foe. Meanwhile in the Empire of Mom's Home Office, on lonely and windswept Desk Mountain, a second great warrior sought the glory of battle. And his name was Paper. *(Paper enters and postures in pantomime)*

Even though he was the smartest warrior in all the land, he was also sad, because no one could outwit him. He set out across Desk Mountain to find his match. There he met a large and square monster.

**COMPUTER PRINTER:** I gobble up the likes of you and spit them out every day, little paper!

**PAPER:** Oh? Then taste my fury, giant box-monster!

**COMPUTER PRINTER:** Noooooo! Not a paper jam!

**NARRATOR:** *(In the voice of a ring announcer)* Paper versus Computer Printer! *(An epic battle ensures – actors depicts both characters in the battle with lots of sounds, but no real words)* Paper is victorious! *(Returns to normal Narrator voice)* Having beaten the fiercest fighter of Desk Mountain, Paper climbed down to the Pit of Office Trash Bin, where he battled the most

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terrifying horde of creatures in all the land . . . the Half-Eaten Bag of Trail Mix!

**NARRATOR:** *(In the voice of a ring announcer)* Paper versus Half-Eaten Bag of Trail Mix!

**TRAIL MIX:** *(but there is no battle because the Trail Mix runs away)* Ahhhhhh! Foul wizard! He's blotted out the sun! Run for your lives, laddies!

**NARRATOR:** Paper wins again!

**PAPER:** Can no one beat me?

**NARRATOR:** And so, with a heavy heart, Paper departed the Empire of Mom's Home Office. At the same time, in the Kitchen Realm, in the tiny village of Junk Drawer, there lived a third great warrior. They called her Scissors, and she was the fastest blade in all the land. *(enter Scissors who postures in pantomime)* She too, was unchallenged. On this day, her first opponent was a strange and sticky circle-man.

**SCISSORS:** *(Scissors spots Roll of Tape and takes a fighting stance)* Let us do battle, you tacky and vaguely round monstrosity!

**TAPE:** I will battle you, and I will leave you beaten and confused with my adhesive and tangling powers!

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**NARRATOR:** *(In the voice of a ring announcer)* Scissors versus Roll of Tape! *(An epic battle ensures – actors depicts both characters in the battle with lots of sounds, but no real words)* Scissors is victorious! *(Returns to normal Narrator voice)* Scissors forged on across the Kitchen Realm to the frigid wastes of Refrigerator/Freezer. There she met her most fearsome adversaries yet . . . dinosaurs made of frozen breaded chicken.

**SCISSORS:** *(Scissors spots the Dinosaurs and takes a fighting stance)* I have come from the far reaches of Kitchen to battle you, O, bizarre and yummy breaded dinosaurs!

**DINOSAUR:** Bow before our child-pleasing shapes and flavors, sword master! No one can resist our crunchy awesomeness!

**NARRATOR:** *(In the voice of a ring announcer)* Scissors versus Dinosaur-Shaped Chicken Nuggets! *(An epic battle ensures – actors depicts both characters in the battle with lots of sounds, but no real words)* Dinosaur-Shaped Chicken Nuggets win . . . ? *(The battle*

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*continues)* No wait! No, they don't! Scissors is victorious again!

**SCISSORS:** Am I so good that not even Dinosaur-Shaped Chicken Nuggets can beat me?

**NARRATOR:** And so Scissors, like Rock and Paper before her, traveled beyond her own kingdom, seeking out a challenger who was her equal. Then one day in the Great Cavern of Two-Car Garage, Rock and Scissors came face-to-face.

**SCISSORS:** I hope you're wearing your battle pants, rock warrior.

**ROCK:** If by "battle pants" you mean "no pants, but I'm willing to fight you," then yes . . . yes, I am wearing my battle pants, weird scissory one!

**NARRTOR:** *(In the voice of a ring announcer)* Rock versus Scissors! *(An epic battle ensures – actors depicts both characters in the battle with lots of sounds, but no real words)* Rock is victorious!

**SCISSORS:** You have made me so happy by beating me!

**ROCK:** I wish I felt your joy, Scissors, for I have yet to meet a warrior who can beat me.

**PAPER:** Hi there.

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**ROCK:** Those are fighting words!

**PAPER:** Wait. What??

**NARRATOR:** *(In the voice of a ring announcer)* Rock versus Paper. *(An epic battle ensures – actors depicts both characters in the battle with lots of sounds, but no real words)*

**ROCK:** This is the best day of my life! Thank you for winning, O great knight of paper!

**PAPER:** That's fine for you, but it looks as thought no one will ever beat me.

**SCISSORS:** Not so fast, Paper

**PAPER:** Wait. What??

**NARRATOR:** *(In the voice of a ring announcer)* Scissors versus Paper! *(An epic battle ensures – actors depicts both characters in the battle with lots of sounds, but no real words)*

**PAPER:** You beat me!

**NARRATOR:** And the three great warriors hugged each other and danced for joy, and they became fast friends. Finally, they had each met their matches. They were so happy, in fact, that they began to battle again. 'Round and 'round they went, in the most massive and epic

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three-way battle of all time! And it is said that this joyous struggle still rages on to this very day. That is why children around the world—in backyards, on playgrounds, and yes, even in classrooms – still honor the three great warriors by playing . . . Rock, Paper, Scissors

## SOURCE INFORMATION

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## AWARD HISTORY

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